

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
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OUR MESSAGE:

**IS ABOUT THE NEED FOR ALL BELIEVERS TO FOCUS ON WHAT THEY
DO HAVE – RATHER THAN ON WHAT THEY DON'T HAVE.**

In this reflection I want to share a thought that has been coming to me over and over again and I feel I need to express some thoughts that I trust will be of help.

My thoughts are drawn from a statement that the apostle made to the church in Corinth in relation to people giving to the poor and those in Jerusalem suffering from severe famine.

2 Corinthians 8:12 For if the eagerness is there, it is acceptable according to what one has, not according to what he does not have. Holman

It is the phrase – “It is acceptable according to what one has, not according to what he does not have”.

2 Corinthians 8:12 For if there be first a willing mind, it is accepted according to that a man hath, and not according to that he hath not. KJV

However, I am not wanting to refer to act of giving in this study

IT IS THE PRINCIPLE THAT IS CONTAINED IN THE APOSTLES' STATEMENT *It is acceptable according to what one has, not according to what he does not have*”, WHICH CAN BE APPLIED IN OTHER ASPECTS OF CHRISTIAN LIFE ALSO.

Sadly, there is a common habit amongst too many people who continue to focus on WHAT THEY DON'T HAVE and FAILING to see what they do have.

It is probably true that everyone has lost something that they loved or had dreams that never eventuated, or positions of ministry or employment that they missed out on, or the setting up/ birthing of a Christian ministry expression that failed and had to be closed, or opportunity they missed because of their lack of experience and poor decisions made or having experienced some tragedy or natural disaster that has left devastation and loss of possessions.

SUCH THINGS SHOULD NOT BE CONSIDERED LIGHTLY OR FRIVOLOUS.

BUT I would like to suggest THAT REGARDLESS OF WHAT HAS HAPPENED TO US WE CAN DEVELOP THE HABIT OF TAKING STOCK OF WHAT WE DO HAVE.

There are too many believers also caught up in this mode of always lamenting what they have lost or never acquired.

And sadly, they continue to live their current present lives in the shadow and clouds of those things that “could have been” or “should have been”.

It is only one small step to take where we start blaming ‘something’ or ‘someone’ for their loss of ‘missing out’.

BUT WHAT ABOUT US DEVELOPING THE HABIT OF FOCUSING ON WHAT WE DO HAVE.

AFTER EVERY STORM IN LIFE, WE MAY HAVE LOST MUCH – BUT IT IS IMPORTANT THAT WE ASK OURSELVES WHAT DO I HAVE LEFT – WHAT REMAINS.

When we recognise on what we do have and start to focus on that then we are able TO BE INVENTIVE and CREATIVE in finding ways that improves our situation both for the present and the future.

Remembering that we can only rebuild our future on what we have and not on those things that we lost or missed out on.

EXAMPLE

I would like to recall some personal events that took place in my life that illustrates this principle that IT IS MORE IMPORTANT WHAT A PERSON HAS, RATHER THAN WHAT HE DOESN'T HAVE OR HAS LOST – refer 2 Corinthians 8:12

PERSONAL TESTIMONY

Some years ago, someone who didn't like us set fire to our first Bethel Church building and burnt it down.

At 3.30 am on a Sunday morning while watching of our Bethel Church building burning down and no fire brigade to save it was evident that nothing was going to be saved as the fire consumed the entire building and all its contents.

I clearly remembering motioning with my hands and saying "Tata" (goodbye) because at that precise moment the Spirit brought to my remembrance prompted a scripture from Micah 7:8

Micah 7:8 Rejoice not against me, O mine enemy: when I fall, I shall arise; when I sit in darkness, the Lord shall be a light unto me. KJV

I could say those words "ta ta" goodbye because I knew deep down FROM what God had SAID "WE SHALL ARISE" that he had plans for the church and the CRC movement to continue – it was not the end.

Literally we had to look at what we did have left that we could use.

Yes, I/we lost many valuable and precious things as did others and from time to time we did think of our loss but only momentary, because our loss was overshadowed with what we still had left and what we could use to take on into tomorrow and beyond.

MAYBE THERE IS A TRUTH HERE FOR ALL OF US –

At that moment when I watched our church burn down, I thought what will we do for that Sunday morning service, shall we cancel it and mourn our loss, or will we have service with what we have at our disposal?

We did have a partly constructed new church building on another piece of land, but it had no roof and no floor (just dirt and muddy) and it was drizzling rain. It was not ideal, and it was difficult but did have Sunday morning service there, with mixed feelings of our loss but also with appreciation for what we did have.

What I have learned out of this tragedy is to look at what we do have after the event, and this was the same thing that we faced after the loss at sea of our evangelism motor launch called the "Mauri Dalana" and then subsequently the crash and loss of our CRC aeroplane P2UIF and six lives including our pilot.

Tragic and devastating though these events were for all of us we still had to consider the immediate and long-term future of the ministry to which we were called. And this meant asking ourselves WHAT DO WE HAVE AFTER THESE TRAGIC EVENTS.

ONE LAST EXAMPLE:

"My cathedral in the jungle"

I have spent many nights in villages and in the jungle with only a mosquito net to cover me which was not always ideal but every night as I lay down with my backpack as my pillow, I would say these words to GOD "This is my cathedral that you have given me tonight and thank you, good night"

I learned to focus on what I do have and not to mourn or complain of the loss of what "could have been" or what others might have.

CAN I ENCOURAGE YOU TO DEVELOP THE HABIT OF FOCUSING ON THE THINGS THAT YOU DO HAVE.

"IT'S BETTER TO BE A LIVE DOG THAN A DEAD LION!"

Ecclesiastes 9:4 There is hope only for the living. As they say, "It's better to be a live dog than a dead lion!" NLT

I may not be very significant in those circles of well-known charismatic or anointed persons BUT I'M ALIVE and that is WHAT I DO HAVE.

I still have all my thinking faculties ("my marbles"), I can make decisions, walk, run, climb, swim, travel, preach and all of that in my estimation beats (is better) than being dead.

I AM ALIVE, so are you!

Amen – Ps Barry